Alejandro Cortes

Chicago, Illinois | hello@alejandrocortes.dev | alejandrocortes.dev |
github.com/acortes8 | linkedin.com/in/acortes-chicago

Objective

Early-career software engineer who builds and deploys full-stack web applications and works with agentic coding workflows. Currently learning TypeScript and C. Experience in software development, automated testing, and cloud-based deployments. Seeking a Software Engineering, Database, DevOps, or tech-adjacent role.

Education

Northeastern Illinois University - Chicago, IL 2022–2023
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, GPA: 3.57
Awards: Cum Laude, Dean's List Recipient

Southern Illinois University - Carbondale, IL 2018–2021
Computer Science

Skills

Languages: English (Native), Spanish (Classroom Study)
Programming Languages: Python, Ruby, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, C
Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite
Web: HTML, CSS
Frameworks & Libraries: Ruby on Rails, Hotwire, Tailwind, Minitest
Tools: Git, macOS, Linux, Windows, Docker, Kamal, Hetzner, Cloudflare, Claude Code, Zed, VS Code

Projects

Cocktail Discovery Web Application buzzysbar.com
- Developing a Rails-based cocktail application using an iterative, feature-driven approach, applying lessons learned from prior projects to improve design and maintainability.
- Implementing automated tests for models and controllers to validate logic and ensure safe iteration as features are added.
- Deployed and self-hosted on a hardened Hetzner VPS, configuring secure access and production-ready deployment practices using Kamal and Docker.

Personal Website acortes8.github.io
- Built a personal knowledge base using Jekyll for project write-ups, step-by-step guides, and technical notes, reducing friction when revisiting or extending past work.
- Leveraged Jekyll themes and Markdown-based publishing to ensure consistent formatting and low-maintenance content updates without backend infrastructure.

E-Commerce Web App pi.depotapp.org
- Built a full-stack e-commerce application by implementing examples from *Agile Web Development with Rails 7*, gaining hands-on experience with Rails MVC architecture, routing, and Active Record.
- Extended the guided implementation by adding a custom contact and questions page, reinforcing understanding of Rails views, routing, and content structure.
- Deployed and self-hosted the application on a Raspberry Pi using Cloudflare Tunnel, gaining experience with infrastructure, proxying, and secure public access.
- Improved usability by extending CSS styling for responsive, mobile-friendly layouts across common screen sizes.

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Leadership Experience

Tech Dawgs - Carbondale, IL 2019–2021

- Managed and documented organizational finances to improve funding visibility; secured new funding sources and established new financial procedures.
- Led requirements analysis for projects by coordinating with others to identify resource needs, allocate budgets, and delegate tasks to members, improving execution and accountability.

Expanding Your Horizons - Carbondale, IL 2018–2021

- Designed and delivered hands-on programming workshops to introduce middle-school students to foundational computer science concepts.
- Adapted technical material to be age-appropriate and engaging, improving comprehension and participation in STEM-focused learning activities.

Boy Scouts of America - Carbondale, IL 2020

- Led interactive workshops introducing K–5 Cub Scouts to basic computer science concepts through activities and guided exercises.
- Simplified abstract technical ideas into accessible lessons to maintain engagement and foster early interest in computing.

TECC Day - Carbondale, IL 2019–2020

- Co-organized the inaugural Technology Exploration for the Carbondale Community (TECC) Day to increase local exposure to technology careers and learning opportunities.
- Coordinated workshops, guest speakers, and event logistics in collaboration with volunteers and stakeholders to deliver a successful community-focused technology event.

Work Experience

Erik's Bike Board Ski - Service Technician / Service Writer March 2026–Present

- Collaborate with sales floor and other mechanics to prioritize daily workload based on task urgency and complexity, resolving issues independently when possible and escalating jobs that need extra attention.
- Repair a wide range of equipment, including conventional and electric bikes, skis, snowboards, and sport accessories.
- Maintain detailed, well-organized notes on repairs in the store's retail management system, covering diagnostics, customer communications, and repair status.
- Assist customers by phone and in person at the service counter, explaining technical issues in plain terms, setting expectations, and answering questions.
- Fill in as the store's service writer: handle repair pick-ups, diagnose incoming bikes, write and schedule repair tickets, and assign work to other mechanics.